

The Dean's List Daily™ Study System

The study schedule that actually works — built for college exam structures

THE SCIENCE BEHIND THIS SYSTEM

Most students study wrong. They re-read notes, highlight, and cram the night before. This feels productive but research shows it doesn't work. This system uses three evidence-backed techniques:

!SPACED REPETITION: Review material at increasing intervals (1 day, 3 days, 7 days, 14 days). Dramatically improves long-term retention.

!ACTIVE RECALL: Instead of re-reading, test yourself. Close the notes and try to recall. Every retrieval strengthens the memory.

!INTERLEAVING: Mix different subjects and topics. Don't study one topic for 4 hours. Alternate between subjects.

THE DAILY SCHEDULE TEMPLATE

This is the framework. Customize times to your class schedule.

!7:00-8:00 AM — Morning review: Spend 30-60 min reviewing yesterday's notes (active recall, not re-reading)

!8:00-12:00 PM — Classes

!12:30-1:00 PM — Lunch + immediate review: Within 30 min of class, review your notes while fresh

!1:00-5:00 PM — Deep Work Block: 2-4 hours of focused studying (see Pomodoro system below)

!5:00-7:00 PM — Break, exercise, social

!7:00-8:00 PM — Evening review: Light review of what you studied today

!8:00-9:00 PM — Prep tomorrow: Review syllabus, know what's coming

!No studying after 10 PM: you retain nothing when exhausted — sleep is the study session

THE POMODORO SYSTEM (FOR DEEP WORK BLOCKS)

The standard Pomodoro is 25 min work / 5 min break. For college studying, use the Extended Pomodoro:

1. 50 minutes of focused work (phone in another room, one tab open)
2. 10 minute break (walk, stretch, water — NOT social media)
3. Repeat 3-4 times = 1 session
4. After 4 Pomodoros: take a 30-minute real break

Track your Pomodoros. Most students think they study for 4 hours but actually study for 1.5 hours with lots of distraction. Counting forces honesty.

!Phone in another room — not face down on the desk. Another room.

!One browser tab maximum. Use Forest app or website blockers if needed.

!If a thought distracts you: write it on a "capture list," don't stop studying to deal with it.

!Tell people around you when your focus block ends so they stop interrupting.

THE EXAM COUNTDOWN SYSTEM

Work backwards from your exam. Assign material to specific days, not just "study for exam."

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MIDTERM & FINALS MODE

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.
- 7.

SEMESTER PLANNING (DO THIS WEEK 1)

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.

